

Using this book

In these pages you can find a country and discover its major features, look at culture and history, and observe wildlife and ecosystems. You can also explore the world of science – from how technology works to what’s going on inside the human body. Enjoy a thrilling journey!

The **First Children’s Encyclopedia** is divided into ten colour-coded chapters so you can see what you are looking for at a glance:

- Our world
- People and society
- History of people
- Human body
- The living world
- Ecosystems and habitats
- Age of the dinosaurs
- Science and technology
- Planet Earth
- The universe

What’s what on a page?

The pages have special features that show you how to get your hands on as much information as possible! Look out for these:

The **Curiosity quiz** will get you searching through each section to find the pictures.

The living world

The living world

Our amazing world is filled with millions of species, or types, of living thing. They can be as big as an elephant or so small you have to look through a microscope to see them.

Animals

The animal kingdom is made up of vertebrates (animals with a backbone) and invertebrates (animals without a backbone).

Micro-organisms

Micro-organisms are very tiny – they are made up of a single cell. This amoeba is magnified more than 100 times.

Plants

Plants cannot move around like animals. To survive and grow, they have to make their own food. In turn, plants provide food for many animals and fungi.

Signs of life

Living things share some characteristics. They all need food and oxygen. They also grow, reproduce, and adapt to their environment.

Fungi

Fungi (like toadstools, mushrooms, and moulds) are neither plants nor animals, but they’re more like plants than animals.

Become an expert

126-127 Types of animals
148-149 How plants work

The living world

Curiosity quiz

Look through The living world pages and see if you can identify the pictures below.

Become an expert

126-127 Types of animals
148-149 How plants work

122 Which group of animals has the most members?

123 Invertebrates – they make up 97 per cent of all animal species.

Become an expert tells you where to look for more information on related subjects.